



Economics 322

The Global Economy: Trade and Development

Summer 2025

Course Section: 001

Meeting Time and Place: M–F 2:00 – 3:40 PM, online via Zoom

Course Credit Hours: 3

Faculty Contact Information

Instructor: Pengzhen Li
Office Hours: 3:40 – 4:40 PM M–F, or by appointment via Zoom
Email: pli26@vols.utk.edu
Meeting Link (class and office hours): <https://tennessee.zoom.us/j/8266363841>

Course Description

This course focuses on the analysis and characterization of economic development. It begins with an overview of the concept of development and cross-country experiences, setting the stage for examining classical, neoclassical, and contemporary theories of growth and development. The second part of the course explores key development challenges, including global poverty, human capital formation, population dynamics, and the environment.

In the final portion of the course, we shift to topics of international relevance, including trade and foreign finance. Students will analyze how trade policies and international financial flows influence development outcomes, particularly in low- and middle-income countries. Policy-making will be discussed throughout, with a focus on how governments can design and implement effective strategies to promote sustainable and inclusive economic growth.

Required Text

Todaro, P. M. and Smith, C. S. (2020). *Economic Development*, 13th Edition. Pearson.

Prerequisites

ECON 201 or ECON 207.

Student Learning Outcomes / Objectives

By the end of the course, students will be able to:

- Characterize economic development across the world and the features defining developing countries.
- Explain the measurements of economic development and their implications.
- Explain the basic theories of why countries have differences in their economic development.
- Critically analyze development policies and their relationship with economic, demographic, socio-political, health, and financial issues.

- Use the key world economic data.
- Leverage empirical data to analyze the process of development across case studies.
- Use empirical data to analyze global trends of development.
- Explain current trends in the science of development economics.

Learning Environment

To facilitate learning for everyone in the class, the following are guidelines to behave professionally and respectfully in this class. Learning is not something that you can be forced to do. It is expected that you approach class with an openness to new ideas, enhance the learning environment of others around you, and take responsibility for your own learning.

Student's Responsibility

- Attend and be prepared for all classes
- Respect class time by logging in by 2:00 PM
- Treat others with kindness and respect
- Actively contribute to the learning activities in class
- Ask questions about concepts or material that is unclear
- Abide by the UT Honor Code

Instructor's Responsibility

- Be prepared for all classes
- Respect class time by concluding class no later than 3:40 PM
- Create and facilitate meaningful learning activities
- Evaluate all fairly and equally
- Be respectful and kind to all students
- Behave according to University codes of conduct

Course Resources

Canvas: This class will use Canvas as the primary location for all class files and assignments. Communication regarding changes to the course or reminders will occur in Canvas announcements.

Technology: Because all quizzes and exams will be conducted using Proctorio on Canvas, a computer with access to a compatible browser is required. There will be a practice quiz prior to the first chapter quiz. If there are issues with Proctorio, students are responsible for resolving these with OIT prior to the first chapter quiz.

Textbook: There will be several quizzes throughout the term directly related to assigned readings in the textbook. As such, access to the textbook is required. In addition, students will be expected to engage in discussion related to end-of-chapter case studies during synchronous classes.

Grading and Evaluation Policies

Chapter Quizzes (20%):

Quizzes based on chapters in the textbook (including case studies!) will be posted to Canvas and will collectively account for 20% of your final grade. All quiz assignments are due by 11:59 PM EST on their due date, unless otherwise noted. I will drop one quiz grade. This is to accommodate unforeseen circumstances or any personal issues that may come up. I will not accept any late quiz submissions.

Exams (70%):

There will be a total of two exams for this course: one midterm and a cumulative final. The midterm will account for 30%, while the final will be worth 40% of your grade in this course and will cover all course material. All exams will be given via Proctorio on Canvas and will be available during a window of time that includes regularly scheduled class. Makeup exams will be available only for University-excused absences.

Participation (10%):

Attendance is mandatory. Although online, this class will have a heavy focus on discussion—particularly regarding end-of-chapter case studies. As such, students are required to have cameras on when attending class via Zoom and participate during in-class assessments and discussions. This assessment may take the form of text responses/polls, exit quizzes, or participation in class discussions. Two points will be available for each class day—1 for attendance, 1 for participation. Unless for a University-excused absence, if you are not in the Zoom call with your camera on, you will lose points for attendance and any participation points for that day. I will drop one day's attendance/participation grade.

Extra Credit (0%):

There will be no opportunities for extra credit that apply towards your finalized grade.

Grading Scale

Chapter Quizzes (average):	20%
Midterm:	30%
Final Exam:	40%
Participation:	10%
Total	100%

Final Course Letter Grades

Course Percentage	Letter Grade
92.0% – 100%	A
90.0% – 91.99%	A–
88.0% – 89.99%	B+
82.0% – 87.99%	B
80.0% – 81.99%	B–
78.0% – 79.99%	C+
72.0% – 77.99%	C
70.0% – 71.99%	C–
68.0% – 69.99%	D+
62.0% – 67.99%	D
60.0% – 61.99%	D–
Less than 59.99%	F

Copyright Policy

The instructor of this class owns the copyright to the syllabus, handouts, assignments, quizzes, and exams associated with the class. All presentations developed by the instructor, as well as the instructor's lectures, are also protected by copyright, whether these presentations and lectures are delivered live in-class, shared through Zoom or other video conference platforms, or uploaded to

Canvas or similar sites.

Sharing any of this material without the written permission of the instructor is a violation of copyright law and is therefore also a violation of the University's policy on acceptable use of information technology resources (UT policy number IT0110). That policy states that students will not commit copyright infringement, "including file sharing of video, audio, or data without permission from the copyright owner", and that file sharing is a violation of the university's student code of conduct. I will report all such violations to the Office of Student Conduct and Community Standards.

Tentative Course Outline

Date	Content	Book Chapter
5/27	Introduction	Ch 1
5/28	Comparative Economic Development	Ch 2
5/29	Comparative Economic Development	Ch 2
5/30	Classic Development Theory	Ch 3
6/02	Classic Development Theory	Ch 3
6/03	Classic Development Theory	Ch 3
6/04	Contemporary Development Theory	Ch 4
6/05	Contemporary Development Theory	Ch 4
6/06	Contemporary Development Theory	Ch 4
6/09	Poverty	Ch 5
6/10	Poverty	Ch 5
6/11	Poverty	Ch 5
6/12	Population	Ch 6
6/13	Population	Ch 6
6/16	Human Capital	Ch 8
6/17	Environment	Ch 10
6/18	Environment	Ch 10
6/19	Holiday	
6/20	Midterm	Ch 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 10
6/23	Policy	Ch 11
6/24	Policy	Ch 11
6/25	Trade	Ch 12
6/26	Trade	Ch 12
6/27	No Class	
6/30	No Class	
7/01	No Class	
7/02	Final Exam	Ch 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 8, 10, 11, 12
*subject to change		

Academic Integrity

Each student is responsible for abiding by the policies and honor code set forth in UT Hill Topics regarding academic integrity. Cheating of any sort including plagiarism will not be tolerated and will result in a grade of F for the course and charge filed with the Dean of Students. It is recognized that any student has the right to appeal a grading decision of an instructor and/or penalties resulting from a charge of academic dishonesty.

UT honor code statement:

“As a student of the University, I pledge that I will neither knowingly give nor receive any inappropriate assistance in academic work, thus affirming my own personal commitment to honor and integrity.”

Disability

Any student who feels they may need an accommodation based on the impact of a disability should contact the instructor privately to discuss specific needs. Please contact the Office of Disability Services at 865-974-6087 in Hoskins Library to coordinate reasonable accommodations for students with documented disabilities.

University Civility Statement

Civility is genuine respect and regard for others: politeness, consideration, tact, good manners, graciousness, cordiality, affability, amiability and courteousness. Civility enhances academic freedom and integrity, and is a prerequisite to the free exchange of ideas and knowledge in the learning community. Our community consists of students, faculty, staff, alumni, and campus visitors. Community members affect each other's well-being and have a shared interest in creating and sustaining an environment where all community members and their points of view are valued and respected. Affirming the value of each member of the university community, the campus asks that all its members adhere to the principles of civility and community adopted by the campus: <http://civility.utk.edu/>.

Key Campus Resources for Students

- [Center for Career Development and Academic Exploration](#) (Career counseling and resources; Handshake job search system)
- [Course Catalogs](#) (Listing of academic programs, courses, and policies)
- [Hilltopics](#) (Campus and academic policies, procedures and standards of conduct)
- [OIT HelpDesk](#) (865) 974-9900
- [Schedule of Classes / Timetable](#)
- [Student Health Center](#) (visit the site for a list of services)
- [Academic Success Center](#) (Academic support resources)
- [Undergraduate Academic Advising](#) (Advising resources, course requirements, and major guides)
- [University Libraries](#) (Access to library resources, databases, course reserves, and services)

Wellness

wellness.utk.edu and counselingcenter.utk.edu

The [Center for Health Education and Wellness](#) empowers all Volunteers to thrive by cultivating personal and community well-being. The Center can answer questions about general wellness, substance use, sexual health, healthy relationships, and sexual assault prevention. The [Student Counseling Center](#) is the university's primary facility for personal counseling, psychotherapy, and psychological outreach and consultation services.

Any student who has difficulty affording hygiene products, groceries, or accessing sufficient food to eat every day is urged to contact the [Big Orange Pantry](#) for support. The Big Orange Pantry, located in Greve Hall, is a free resource for all students, faculty, and staff, no matter how great or small their need is. Students who need emergency financial assistance can also request funding from the [Student Emergency Fund](#).

Students who are experiencing non-academic difficulty or distress and need assistance should call 974-HELP or [submit an online referral](#). The 974-HELP team specializes in aligning resources and support to students experiencing mental health distress.

Your Role in Improving the Course Through Assessment

At UT, it is our collective responsibility to improve the state of teaching and learning. During the semester you may be requested to assess aspects of this course, either during class or at the completion of the class, and through the TNVoice course evaluation. Please take the few moments needed to respond to these requests as they are used by instructors, department heads, deans and others to improve the quality of your UT learning experience.

The instructor reserves the right to revise, alter or amend this syllabus as necessary. Students will be notified in writing / email of any such changes.